

Wembley - Saturday 12th May

Arsenal 3 Manchester United 2

Arsenal

(Talbot, Stapleton, Sunderland)

Manchester United

(Pearson, Greenhoff J)

Referee: R Challis

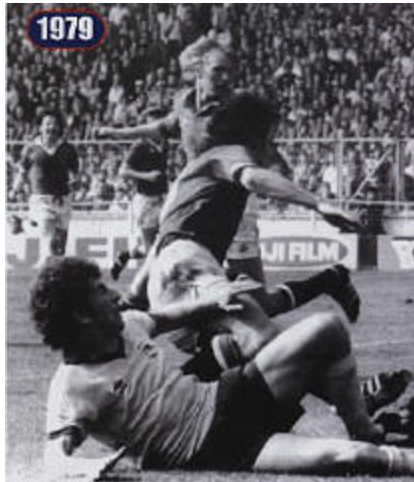
Jennings, Rice, Nelson, Talbot, O'leary, Young, Brady, Sunderland, Stapleton, Price(Walford), Rix

Bailey, Nicholl, Albiston, McIlroy, McQueen, Buchan, Coppell, Greenhoff J, Jordan, Macari, Thomas

Attendance: 100,000



MATCH REPORT



Arsenal seemed to be coasting home, 2-0 in the lead with only five minutes of a fairly undistinguished match left, when three almost unbelievable events occurred, so that in the end it all added up to one of the most fantastic and dramatic Finals of recent years.

United had clearly decided that Brady was their most menacing opponent, and Macari attempted to mark him closely. But Brady lost his shadow in the twelfth minute and swung out a long pass to Stapleton. A through pass to Price, a quick centre, and three Arsenal players dashed for the ball in the goalmouth. Talbot won the race and put Arsenal one up.

United, apparently unshaken, had most of the play for the next half-hour, but they went further behind just before half-time. Brady was again the architect, as his

floated cross from the right was headed in with the minimum of fuss by Stapleton.

An eighty-fifth minute substitution - Walford for Price - may well have upset Arsenal's rhythm. First McQueen was on the spot to score for United following Coppell's free-kick, and then, improbably, United drew level through McIlroy.

But they had hardly finished congratulating themselves when Brady produced a perfectly controlled diagonal run before feeding Rix out on the left, and the latter's curving centre to the far post was shot home by Sunderland for a last-minute Arsenal winner.

